

Language development 1

Reporting exact words

- 1 a Iris and George married 50 years ago. In what ways do you think customs before marriage were different then?
- b Read what Iris says and answer the questions.
 - 1 Why didn't Iris accept George's proposal immediately?
 - 2 What does she think is the secret of a happy marriage?

'George was taking me home from the cinema and he suddenly asked me if I would marry him. I didn't say anything. He asked what the matter was. I replied that we'd only met the previous summer and said that we'd only known each other for a year. He said he loved me. I told him to ask my father, and of course my father said "Yes"! Somebody once asked me what the secret of a happy marriage is. I replied that nothing's changed – the husband still has to be the "king of the castle"!'

- c Complete the table with the exact words each person used.

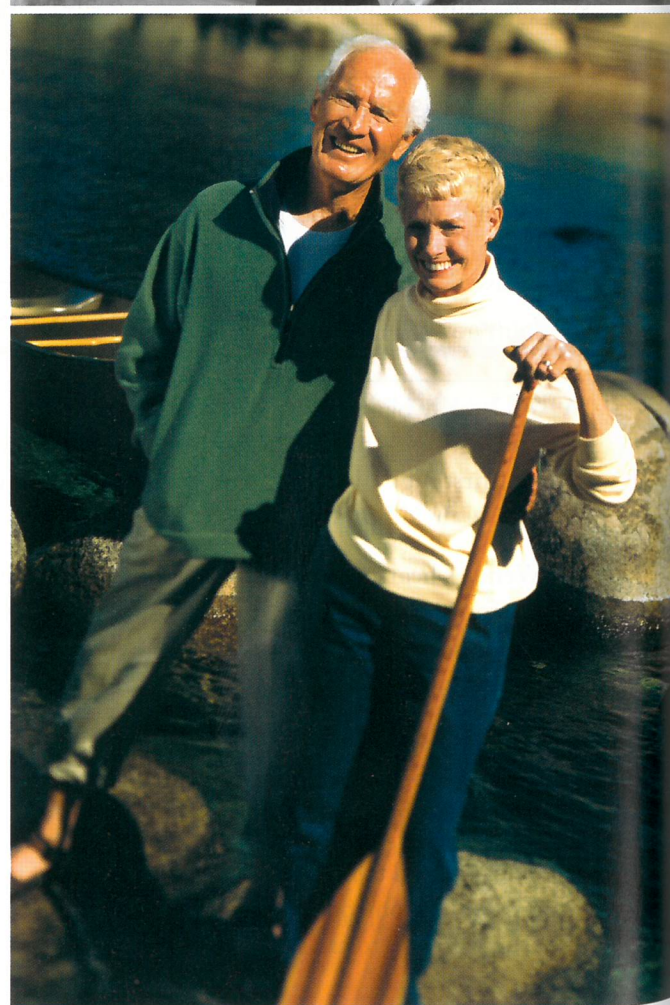
Present simple 1 'I?'	Past simple He said he loved me.
Present perfect 2 'We each other for a year.'	Past perfect I said that we'd only known each other for a year.
Past simple 3 'We only summer.'	Past perfect I replied that we'd only met the previous summer.
Imperative 4 '..... my father.'	tell + object + to + infinitive I told him to ask my father.
Yes/No question 5 '..... marry me?'	He asked me if I would marry him.
Wh- question 6 'What the matter?'	He asked what the matter was.
No tense change 7 'What the secret of a happy marriage?'	Somebody asked me what the secret of a happy marriage is.
8 'Nothing?'	I replied that nothing's changed.

- d Why is there no tense change in examples 7 and 8?

► Grammar reference pages 203–204

- e What do these words and expressions usually change to in reported speech?

today tomorrow yesterday last week
next month this here come bring



- 2 Read the conversation, then complete the text below.

TIM: Hi Sarah, it's Tim. What are you doing tonight?

SARAH: You're nosy! Anyway, I'm studying.

TIM: That's boring – come out for a meal instead.

SARAH: Well, I've nearly finished, I suppose. Which restaurant do you have in mind?

TIM: That new Indian one. I went there last week – it's great.

SARAH: OK, then. Can you pick me up?

TIM: Sure. I'll be there at seven.

SARAH: Great. I must be back early though.

Tim took me out last night – he called and asked me (1) doing, so I said that (2) studying. He said (3) boring, and told me (4) for a meal instead. I replied that (5) finished and asked him which restaurant he (6) in mind. He told me that he (7) the new Indian restaurant the previous week, and that (8) great. I asked him (9) up, and he said he (10) there at seven. I said I (11) back early.

- 3 a Tell each other about a person, place or pet that is important to you. As you listen, ask each other questions and make notes.
- b Report your conversations to the rest of the group.

Reporting verbs

- 4 a Complete the 'report' of Sarah and Tim's conversation with these verbs.

accused agreed explained
persuaded suggested

1 Sarah Tim of being nosy.

2 Tim Sarah to go out for a meal.

3 She to go out for a meal.

4 Tim going to the new Indian restaurant.

5 He that he'd been there before.
- b Write the verbs in Exercise 4a in the correct place in the table.

verb + to	
verb + object + to	
verb + -ing	
verb (+ object) + prep + -ing	
verb (+ object) + that + clause	

- c Now write these verbs in the correct place in the table.

admit advise apologise decide
deny insist offer refuse remind
recommend warn

- d Which verbs in Exercises 4b and c could go into more than one place in the table?

► Grammar reference page 204

- 5 Report what the people say, using a reporting verb from Exercise 4.
 - 1 'You shouldn't get married yet,' Jane's father told her. Jane's father
 - 2 'I started the argument,' Nadia said. Nadia
 - 3 'I don't care what you say, I'm cooking dinner tonight,' Paul said. Paul
 - 4 'Don't go out with Mike, he's not nice,' Adela told her sister. Adela
 - 5 'I'm sorry if I hurt your feelings,' Nick told his girlfriend. Nick
 - 6 'Why don't we stay in this weekend?' Mark said. Mark
 - 7 'I'll carry that bag for you,' Marta said to her mother. Marta
 - 8 'I'm not listening!' Carol said. Carol

- 6 Complete these sentences about yourself.

- 1 Once I had to apologise ...
- 2 ... asked me if ...
- 3 ... persuaded me ...
- 4 I've decided ...

- 7 Make sentences from these words.

- 1 Sometimes people / suggest / marriage / old-fashioned idea.
- 2 Parents often / persuade / children / get married.
- 3 Some people / insist / get married / while / still teenagers.
- 4 One couple / admit / get married / for financial reasons.
- 5 Some couples / refuse / have / religious wedding.
- 6 A few women / decide / not / change their surname.